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Isao Takahata
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(2013), through his notebooks and storyboards, original drawings, cels, film and video excerpts and audiovisual documents.

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Exhibition

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A Pioneer of Contemporary Animation, from the Post-war Era to Studio Ghibli

The exhibition, unique in Switzerland, retraces Takahata's career, from *Heidi, Girl of the Alps* (1974) to *Grave of the Fireflies* (1988) and *The Tale of The Princess Kaguya* (2013), through his notebooks and storyboards, original drawings, cels, film and video excerpts and audiovisual documents.

It also highlights an entirely new aspect: the special ties Takahata maintained with the West throughout his life, from his intellectual education to his role as a cultural bridge, and the accuracy of his depictions of the European world in landmark works such as *Heidi, Girl of the Alps* (1974).

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This part of the exhibition explores Isao Takahata's decisive relationship with the West, particularly the French-speaking world. It retraces his discovery of Prévert's poetic realism – a foundation of both his aesthetic and political engagement – and presents his in-depth research into *The Shepherdess and The Chimney-Sweep* (1953), through original documents that shed light on the origins of his vocation. It then examines the unprecedented challenge of adapting classic Western stories into animation – *Heidi, Girl of the Alps* (1974), *From The Apennines to The Andes* (1976), *Anne of Green Gables* (1979) – combining ethnographic rigour with documentary ambition. Finally, it highlights Takahata's exchanges with Western artists (Grimault, Ocelot, Back, Norstein and many others), his influence on world animation and his major role in establishing animated film as a recognised art form. This journey illustrates the importance of sustained cultural exchange, portraying Takahata as a key figure in intercultural dialogue and a source of inspiration across borders.

Isao Takahata



Isao Takahata (1935–2018) is regarded as one of the great masters of world animation.

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traditional codes and turning it into an art form in its own right, recognised for what he himself called “the invention of animated reality”

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Biography



Born in 1935 in Mie Prefecture, Isao Takahata graduated from the University of Tokyo (Department of French Literature) in 1959. That same year, he joined Toei Animation. In 1968, he directed his first feature film for theatrical release: *The Great Adventure of Horus, Prince of the Sun* (1968). In 1971, Takahata joined the studio A Production. In 1974, he directed the 52 episodes of *Heidi, Girl of the Alps*, an animated television series adapted from a classic of children's literature. He later directed all episodes of the TV series *From The Apennines to The Andes* (1976) and *Anne of Green Gables* (1979), also based on children's novels. He directed the feature films *Jarinko Chie* (1981) and *Gauche the Cellist* (1982) the following year. Hayao Miyazaki's *Nausicaä of the Valley of the Wind*, released in 1984, was the first feature film he produced.

Takahata co-founded Studio Ghibli with Hayao Miyazaki and Toshio Suzuki in 1985. For this studio, he directed several films: *Grave of the Fireflies* (1988), *Only Yesterday* (1991), *Pom Poko* (1994), and *My Neighbors the Yamadas* (1999). *The Tale of The Princess Kaguya* (2013), his final masterpiece, was selected for the Directors' Fortnight at Cannes (2014) and was nominated for the Academy Award for Best Animated Feature (2015). Takahata was awarded the Honoric Leopard at Locarno International Film Festival (2009).

Isao Takahata was also the author of numerous works, including *Eiga wo Tsukurinagara Kangaeta Koto* (Reflections While Making Films, not translated), *Jyuni-Seiki no Animation* (12th Century Animation, not translated), *Animation Ori ni Furete* (Animation, on Various Occasions, not translated), among others.

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Partner



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Meet us at Plateforme 10, Lausanne's arts district!

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10:00 – 18:00

Thursday

10:00 – 20:00

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